Portable MIDI Sequencer — Public Alpha 1 (Project Overview)
Overview
Portable MIDI Sequencer Alpha 1 is a **hardware-first, performance-oriented MIDI sequencer** designed for musicians who prefer playing music rather than programming grids.
It is built as a **centerpiece for dawless setups**, focusing on real-time MIDI performance capture, multi-track recording, and reliable standalone operation — without requiring a computer.
Philosophy
This project prioritizes **musical flow and immediacy** over visual complexity.
Instead of deep menu systems or step-based programming, Alpha 1 is designed as an **instrument** that responds directly to human timing, dynamics, and intent.
The minimal screen is used to support orientation and feedback — not to dominate the creative process.
Who It's For
Alpha 1 is especially well-suited for:
- Keyboard players and MIDI controller users
- Musicians comfortable with live timing and rhythm
- Dawless performers looking for a central MIDI brain
- Users who prefer recording real performances over step editing
It is **not intended** as a grid-based step sequencer or a DAW replacement.
Core Capabilities
- Live MIDI recording
- 16 independent tracks / MIDI channels
- Multi-device control via MIDI routing
- Loop and linear sequencing modes
- Reliable save/load directly on hardware
- Compact, portable hardware form factor
Hardware Interface
- MIDI TRS In / Out (compatible with 5■pin DIN via adapters)
- 0.96" OLED display
- 8 physical buttons
- Rotary encoder
- 8 status LEDs for immediate visual feedback
Synchronization
Current version:
- Internal clock (master mode)
Planned:
- MIDI Clock In / Out for external sync
Alpha 1 currently operates intentionally as a **clock master**, reinforcing its role as a setup centerpiece.
Development Stage
Alpha 1 is released as a **Public Alpha** to:
- Evaluate the core sequencing workflow in practical musical use
- Collect focused user feedback to guide future architectural and workflow decisions
Features and firmware will evolve based on real-world use.
